GRANT ON PURPOSE.

GUIDELINES FOR DONOR ADVISED GRANTMAKING

Donor impact. Your passion is our purpose. We can make it happen.



Berry Junction Trail

This is our philosophy on donor advised grantmaking. We do everything we can to accommodate your desires within the IRS regulations that govern Donor Advised Funds (DAFs). In order to safeguard the deductibility of your gift to the Foundation – and our charitable status – there are a few things we need to tell you about grantmaking.

Grants

We are happy to process grant recommendations from your fund to any qualified nonprofit organization in the United States. Since we serve Muskegon County, we do ask that the majority of your grants support local organizations. If you're interested in supporting international efforts, we can work together to see if there is a qualified agency to whom we can make a grant.

Grant Size & Frequency

In light of the staff time and processing costs associated with each grant recommendation, we ask that your grants be for $100 or more. There is no limit to the number of grants you can make…we love donors who grant often!

Pledges

The IRS does not allow grants from a DAF to fulfill pledges that you have made personally or through a business. If you want to support an organization's project for multiple years, you can recommend that your DAF make a multi-year commitment. Contact us and we'll work together to make it happen.

Grants to Individuals

The IRS doesn't allow us to make grants to individuals, nor can we approve grants to an organization that will benefit an individual you have identified. For instance, we can't make a grant to a school when it is designated for tuition support for someone you know.

Tickets and Memberships

Your fund can't make a grant that provides you with benefits such as events, dinners, or memberships with substantial benefits or services. We can, however, support the deductible portion of an event or membership contribution (which the organization will state on the invitation). You can personally pay the non-deductible portion and suggest a grant from your DAF for the balance.



Read Muskegon

Personal Benefit

Your fund can't be used to make grants, loans, or similar payments (including expense reimbursements) to yourself or your family. Grants from your fund have no tax impact. However, gifts to the fund are tax deductible!

Research on Recipients

We perform due diligence on every organization recommended to receive a grant. In addition to verifying nonprofit status with the IRS, we also collect information about programs, finances, governance, etc. for many organizations. If you have questions, please contact us.

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